



Emotion Cards Pilot Instructions

Support material for teachers, tutors, and specialists participating in the pilot program

Thank You for Participating in the Pilot Program

We invite you to test the Emotion Cards while working with students.

The goal of the pilot program is to explore how the cards help:

- talk about emotions,
 - build a positive classroom atmosphere,
 - develop communication and empathy,
 - strengthen group integration,
 - support students in expressing their thoughts and needs.
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What Is Included in the Set?

● **Navy Blue Cards** – 22 cards featuring illustrations that represent emotions, situations, and metaphorical scenes.

● **Green Cards** – 18 cards containing supportive questions that help start conversations about emotions, needs, relationships, and associations.

The cards can be freely combined in any way.

Who Can Use the Cards?

- teachers,
 - homeroom teachers,
 - school counselors,
 - psychologists,
 - specialists working with children and adolescents.
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Pilot Program Task

Please **conduct 2–3 activities** using the cards during:

- lessons,
- individual sessions,
- group sessions.

The activities can:

- take place during a single session,
or
 - be spread across several meetings.
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Guidelines for Working with the Cards

 **At the beginning, it is helpful to tell students:**

- “There are no right or wrong answers.”
- “Everyone can share as much as they want.”
- “You can talk about the picture instead of talking about yourself.”

 **During the activities:**

- start with simple and light questions,
- thank students for their responses,
- allow students to interpret the images in their own way,
- do not force anyone to answer,
- maintain a calm and supportive atmosphere.

 **What to Avoid:**

- judging responses,
- interpreting students,
- asking overly personal questions,
- putting pressure on students,
- extending activities for too long.

Activity Suggestions

Each activity can be adapted to the students’ age, group size, and available time. The facilitator may shorten, expand, or modify the activities to ensure they feel comfortable and safe for the group.

Activity 1 – Discover Emotions

Format: whole class / group

Time: 10–15 minutes

Goal

- help students become familiar with the cards,
- encourage conversations about emotions,
- develop associations and imagination.

Preparation

- prepare the navy blue and green card decks,
- sit in a circle or at tables,
- shuffle both decks separately.

Instructions

1. Tell the students:
“In a moment, we will work with emotion cards. There are no right or wrong answers here. Everyone can respond in their own way.”
2. Ask one student to draw a navy blue card.
3. The student then draws one green question card.
4. Read the question aloud or ask the student to read it.
5. The student answers using the illustration as a reference.
6. If the student does not want to answer:
 - they may pass the question to someone else,
 - answer with one word,
 - or simply name the emotion shown in the picture.
7. After the response:
 - thank the student,
 - you may ask follow-up questions such as:
 - “What else caught your attention?”
 - “Does anyone see it differently?”
8. Repeat the activity with other students.

Variations

Variation 1 – One Card for Everyone

- show one card to the entire class,
- different students draw different green question cards and answer them.

Variation 2 – Pair Work

- each pair receives one navy blue card and 2–3 green question cards,
- students first discuss the questions together,
- volunteers may later share their responses with the class.

Variation 3 – Quick Associations

- the student responds with only one word or a short sentence.
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Activity 2 – Emotion Gallery

Format: movement-based activity

Time: approximately 15 minutes

Goal

- activate the group,
- encourage conversations about emotions,
- practice expressing opinions.

Preparation

- place the navy blue cards around the room,
- leave enough space for students to move freely.

Instructions

1. Say:
“In a moment, you will look at different illustrations. Choose one card that attracts your attention the most.”
2. Students walk around the room and look at the illustrations.
3. After a moment, ask everyone to stand next to their chosen card.
4. Ask one question, for example:
 - “What caught your attention?”
 - “What emotion does this card show?”
 - “Why did you choose this illustration?”
5. Students discuss in pairs, small groups, or as a whole class.

Variations

Variation 1 – Classroom Mood

Say: “Choose a card that best represents the mood of our group today.”

Students then explain their choices.

Variation 2 – Silent Gallery

- students do not talk,
- they write down their associations on sticky notes,
- and place them next to the cards.

Variation 3 – Question Walk

- place a green question card next to each illustration (the set contains 22 image cards and 18 question cards, so one question can be used for two illustrations or only selected illustrations may be used),
 - students move from image to image and answer the questions.
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Activity 3 – Voice of the Character

Format: individual or pair work

Time: 10 minutes

Goal

- develop empathy,
- practice speaking skills,
- explore different perspectives.

Preparation

- prepare the navy blue and green cards,
- students may sit in a circle.

Instructions

1. Students choose one character from an illustration.
2. Say:
“Imagine that you are this character.”
3. Ask the student to complete the sentence:

- “I am from this card and I would like to say that...”
 - “Right now I feel...”
 - “I need...”
4. If the student finds it difficult to begin, you may help with questions such as:
 - “What is this character afraid of?”
 - “What are they waiting for?”
 - “What would they like to hear?”
 5. After the response, thank the student and move on to the next person.

Variations

Variation 1 – Interview with the Character

- one person becomes the character from the card,
- the other asks questions like a reporter.

Sample questions:

- “What happened?” “How do you feel now?” “Who can help you?”

Variation 2 – Character Letter

- the student writes a few sentences as the character from the illustration.

Variation 3 – What Happens Next?

- the student continues the character’s story.
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Activity 4 – The Character’s Story

Format: pairs or groups

Time: 15–20 minutes

Goal

- develop imagination and empathy,
- encourage cooperation,
- practice communication skills.

Preparation

- divide students into pairs or small groups,
- each group receives one navy blue card.

Instructions

1. Say:
“Your task is to create a story about the character from the illustration.”
2. Ask the groups to answer together:
 - Who is this character?
 - How old are they?
 - What might have happened?
 - What are they feeling?
 - What do they need?
 - What will happen next?
3. Give the groups a few minutes to discuss.
4. Then each group presents their story.
5. After the presentation, you may ask the class:
 - “Did anyone imagine the story differently?”

Variations

Variation 1 – Character Dialogue

- the group draws two cards,
- students create a conversation between the characters.

Variation 2 – Mini Role-Play

- students act out a short scene without preparation.

Variation 3 – The Next Chapter

- the group draws or describes what happened later.
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Activity 5 – Group Consensus

Format: small groups

Time: approximately 20 minutes

Goal

- cooperation,
- listening to others,
- learning about different perspectives.

Preparation

- divide the class into groups of 3–5 students,
- each group receives:
 - one navy blue card,
 - 2–3 green question cards,
 - a sheet of paper.

Instructions

1. Say:
“Your task is to agree on answers together. It is important that everyone has a chance to share their opinion.”
2. Students take turns answering the questions.
3. The group chooses shared answers or writes down different ideas.
4. After a few minutes, the groups present their conclusions.
5. At the end, ask:
 - “Was it difficult to reach a common answer?”
 - “Did anyone change their mind after the discussion?”

Variations

Variation 1 – Poster

- the group writes their answers on a large sheet of paper,
- and adds keywords or drawings.

Variation 2 – Mind Map

- students write associations around the illustration.

Variation 3 – Create Your Own Question

- the group creates an additional question for the card and asks it to the class.
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Activity 6 – Stress Relief

Format: individual or pair work

Time: 15–20 minutes

Goal

- recognizing emotions,

- building a sense of control,
- exploring coping strategies.

Preparation

- spread the cards on a table or on the floor.

Instructions

1. Say:
“Find cards that show difficult emotions, stress, or tension.”
2. Then ask:
“Now choose a card that represents calmness, relief, or safety.”
3. Ask the question:
“What can help someone move from one state to the other?”
4. Students:
 - write down ideas,
 - discuss in pairs,
 - or create their own action plan.
5. Volunteers may share their ideas.

Variations

Variation 1 – Three Steps

The student writes:

1. What stresses me out?
2. What can I do before a difficult situation?
3. What helps me calm down?

Variation 2 – Path to Calm

- the student draws a path between two cards,
- and writes coping strategies along the way.

Variation 3 – My Resource

- the student completes the sentence:
 - “It helps me when...”

Activity 7 – My Emotion Card

Format: individual work

Time: approximately 25 minutes

Goal

- emotional expression, building a sense of safety,
- developing creativity.

Preparation

Prepare:

- paper, scissors,
- crayons, markers,
- magazines or colored paper.

Instructions

1. Say:
“Now you will create your own emotion card.”
2. Students may draw:
 - an emotion, a situation, their mood,
 - something important to them,
 - their strength or support.
3. After finishing, students:
 - show their cards, give them a title,
 - answer selected green question cards.
4. At the end, thank everyone for their work and responses.

Variations

Variation 1 – My Day

- the student illustrates their day or week on the card.

Variation 2 – My Superpower

- the student presents a personal strength or something that gives them strength.

Variation 3 – Emotion Collage

- instead of drawing, students create a collage using magazine cutouts and art materials.

 After the Pilot Program

We would appreciate brief feedback. Please complete the survey:

use the link:

<https://forms.gle/pr7UScGWV5rfiK1J9>

or QR code:



Thank you for your participation!